Introduction to consulting

Anoushka Singh
Vasundhara Gupta

What would you like to cover today?

Session for today

What is consulting?	• Types of firms • Nature of work • Career paths • Consulting proposition
What happens in a consulting interview?	• Interview walkthrough • Areas of testing • Diffentiators
How do you prep for it?	• Prep areas • Frameworks & cheat sheets • Real life case examples

Q&A

What is Consulting?

Types of firms

Management consulting firms
Trusted advisors to CEOs/Boards
Tackle strategic problem

The BIG 4
Multi-line firms, focused on audits
Provide specific services for execution & consulting

Boutique Firms
Specialised in either a function or an industry

What is Consulting?

Nature of work

Define strategy

How do I stay ahead of competition?

- New Business Builds
- New products
- New customer targets

What should I do to execute?

- GTM Strategy
- M&A Strategy
- Organisation build out

How to optimise my business?

- Cost optimisation
- Process optimisation
- Capability development

Pilot execution

- Ideas to action
- Develop MVP
- Plan to scale

Types of programs

- Revenue acceleration
- Due Diligence
- Cost optimization
- Organization transformation
- Restructuring & Transformation
- Digital transformation

Session for today

What is consulting?

- Types of firms
- Nature of work
- Career paths
- Consulting proposition

What happens in a consulting interview?

- Interview walkthrough
- Areas of testing
- Dos and Don’ts

How do you prep for it?

- Prep areas
- Frameworks and cheat sheets
- Real life case examples

Q&A

Interview Key Points

Areas of Testing

0–5 mins | Kickoff

- Quick self-intro
- Outline session flow

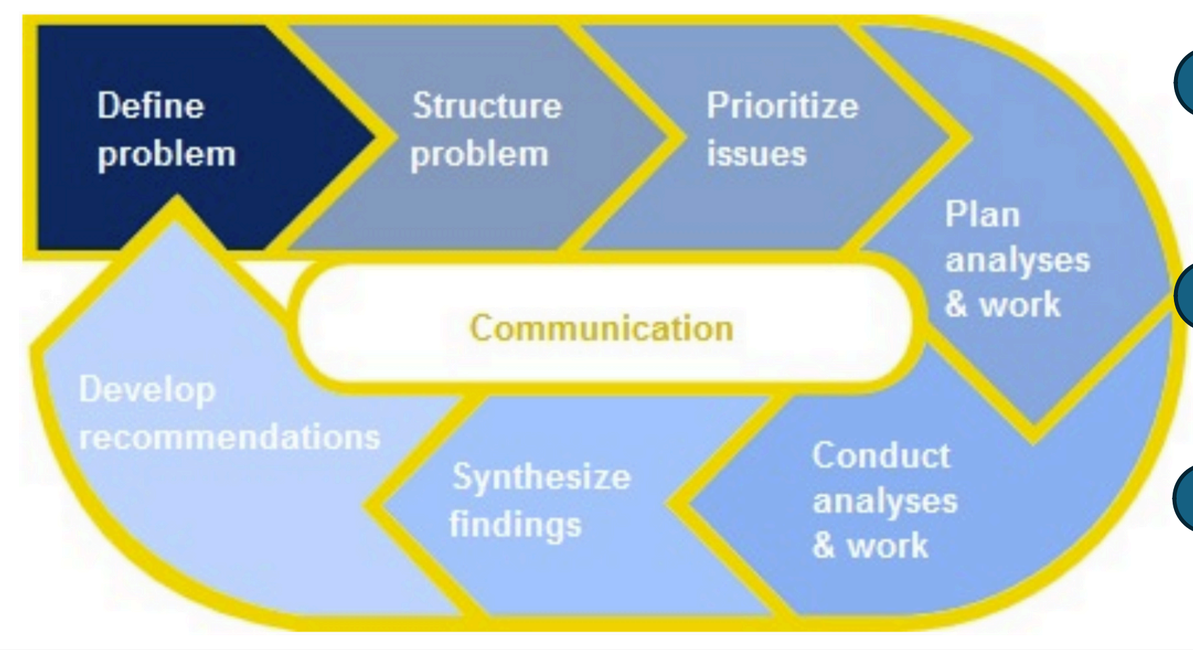
5–30 mins | Case Practice (25 mins)

30–35 mins | Q&A (5 mins)

- They want to understand your interest & motivation
- Be natural — they know you want to impress
- Prepare a few smart questions to ask back

How do you prep for it? First Principles

- **6 step problem solving framework**



1. **Define the problem and make it SMART**
   Specific **M**easurable **A**ctionable **R**elevant **T**ime-bound
2. **Structure the problem**
   Make it MECE – mutual exclusive, collectively exhaustive; ensure constraints and criteria of success are known
3. **Prioritize issues**
   Perfect way to engage the interviewer, probe on what will drive maximum impact; use 80-20 approach to prioritize; leverage an issue tree
4. **Plan and conduct analyses**
   List out ways you can analyse the problem in more detail to get to the solution
5. **Synthesise findings**
   Do not summarise, but synthesise- focus on top down approach, think of this like an elevator pitch for a CEO to buy into the initiative
6. **Develop recommendations**
   Focus on also how you achieve this, rather than only what needs to be done

Common Case Types

1 Profitability Cases

A typical profitability problem would look like: “Your profits are down by 20%, analyse the reason for the same by isolating
the problem.”

2 Market Entry Cases

A market entry case usually involves a firm expanding its offerings to new geographies or venturing into a new product/service
line. You are required to advise them on whether they should enter the market and if yes, how?

3 Growth Cases

A typical growth problem would look like “You need to increase your client’s revenue by 40% in the next 2 years.”

4 Mergers and Acquisitions

These are case studies that focus on valuation, deal structuring, and strategic fit between two companies considering a merger or acquisition. They test analytical, financial, and strategic decision-making skills in a transaction.

5 Pricing Cases

Pricing problems typically require you to help determine the price of a product for a company. This product is, more often than
not, an innovation or patented product that is being introduced for the first time.

6 Unconventional Cases

These are non-traditional business cases that go beyond typical profitability or M&A, often involving creative problem-solving around new markets, social impact, or unique organizational challenges.

How to prep for it? | Unconventional Case

Dear Consultants,
Your client, Game of Thrones, has seen a decline in revenue for its final season, please help

Dear Consultants,
Your client, Santa Claus has been getting delayed in delivering gifts to children this cycle, please help him

Q&A

Some cheat sheets and frameworks

Resources List

- Aditya Agarwal Case Study Playlist
- SRCC Case Compendium
- FMS
- Victor Cheng Case Interview Secrets
- IIMA Case Book (advanced stages only)
- IIM Lucknow Youtube Case Walkthroughs
- Some common frameworks:

1. 4 Ps – Product, Price, Place and Promotion
2. Porters 5 forces – Barrier to entry, Competitive Intensity, Supplier Power, Bargain Power and Substitution Threat
3. PESTLE – Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Legal and Environmental
4. PPI – People, process, infrastructure